

PROGRESSION • TIMELINE • SERIES

kanban

Kanban board — columns of cards by stage.

The board tracks cards across lanes.



KANBAN KEYLINE

keyline rules the lanes apart.

BACKLOG

Ruled lanes

S

IN PROGRESS

Same board

M

DONE

New look

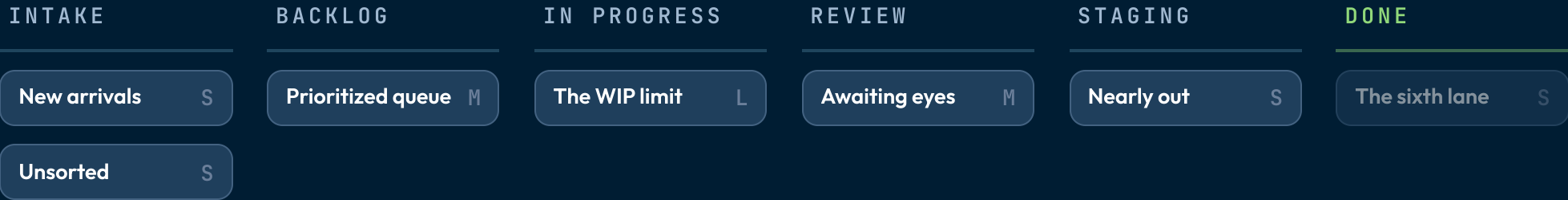
L

KANBAN TINTED

tinted colors each lane's wash.



Six lanes is the board's hard ceiling.



The board tracks cards across lanes.



The board tracks cards across lanes.

BACKLOG

Waiting cards

S

IN PROGRESS

The active limit

M

REVIEW

Almost done

S

DONE

Shipped work

L

The board tracks cards across lanes.

BACKLOG

Waiting cards S

IN PROGRESS

The active limit M

REVIEW

Almost done S

DONE

Shipped work L

When NOT to reach for kanban.

Schedule, If the question is when each task ships **not status.** rather than where it sits today, reach for **ganttt** (spans) or **roadmap** (phases). Kanban is a snapshot, not a timeline.

More than five lanes. Past five columns the cards compress and the column headers crowd. Group adjacent stages or split into two boards (e.g. by team) instead.

Cards without meta. A board of bare titles wastes the layout's affordances. Add at least a size badge and a lane label so the audience can scan workload and ownership at a glance.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`gantt` — schedule of overlapping tasks across lanes, not current state

`roadmap` — phased grid of deliverables across workstreams

`checklist` — single list of items with done/in-flight/planned states

`verdict-grid` — options scored against shared criteria, not stage-tracked